

A Game of Connection: A connection between Go and friendships

THE TEXT (Corrected Version)

Note: Only grammar and spelling errors have been corrected. Corrections are shown in bold.

A trip of memories

Yesterday morning, I **stumbled** upon a photo album when I was organizing several shelves in my room. I **had** almost no recollection of this thing. Out of curiosity, I tried to open the old album softly. All of **a** sudden, my childhood memories appeared clearly in my mind— A gentle smiling face looked toward me..... Then, I embarked on a journey of memories. That moment, **was** full of peace and **warmth**.

A peaceful encounter in kindergarten

Jola — a girl with **long** brown hair — is my best friend of all. I first met her on the first day of kindergarten. **Before adapting to** this new environment, my mind **was** filled with fear and anxiety. When everyone in class was picking the activities to attend, I discovered a line of small print by accident: “Why not learn Go with me? Let’s discover the secret behind the chess! — Ms. Lee”

Play Go? I **signed up for** the club with **uncertainty** and novelty.....

The **first** time **at** the Go club, I **was** assigned to the same group as a girl with pretty eyes. **After** a simple greeting, we **learned** Go under Ms. Lee and **played** Go happily together. Before we **knew it**, we **ended** our first lesson together. The girl, named Jola, **was** fantastic at painting and also **loved** to read. Because of our shared interests, we quickly became **friends**. And until now, our **friendship** has never wavered.

Furthermore, the Go club **was** surprisingly interesting. **Although** it was a little difficult for me **in** the first **place**, I made rapid progress under the teacher’s **patient** step-by-step **guidance**.

Reflection after a game

Go is really a great **game** that **challenges** not **only** our thinking ability **but** also **provides** opportunities that **teach us** how to solve **difficulties** calmly by **ourselves**.

Go is a wonderful hobby that **has** connected my friendships and **abilities** — I **closed** the album softly after **immersing myself** in my lovely **memories**.

THE TEXT (Improved Version)

Note: This version improves clarity and flow while preserving the original voice and meaning.

A trip of memories

Yesterday morning, I stumbled upon a dusty photo album while organizing several shelves in my room. I had almost no recollection of it. Out of curiosity, I gently opened the old album. All of a sudden, my childhood memories came flooding back — a gentle, smiling face gazed at me from the pages..... I found myself drawn into a journey of memories, carried along by a quiet sense of peace and warmth.

A peaceful encounter in kindergarten

Jola — a girl with long brown hair — is my dearest friend. I first met her on my very first day of kindergarten. Before I had a chance to adapt to this unfamiliar environment, my mind was filled with fear and anxiety. While everyone in class was choosing activities to attend, I noticed a line of small print by accident: “Why not learn Go with me? Let’s discover the secret behind the chess! — Ms. Lee”

Play Go? I signed up for the club, filled with a mixture of uncertainty and curiosity.....

On my first day at the Go club, I was assigned to the same group as a girl with bright, pretty eyes. After a simple greeting, we began learning Go under Ms. Lee and played happily together. Before we knew it, our first lesson had come to an end. The girl, named Jola, turned out to be fantastic at painting and also passionate about reading. Because of our shared interests, we quickly became close friends. And to this day, our friendship has never wavered.

What surprised me even more was how fascinating the Go club turned out to be. Although it was a little challenging for me at first, I made rapid progress under the teacher’s patient, step-by-step guidance.

Reflection after a game

Go is truly a remarkable game that not only challenges our thinking ability but also provides valuable opportunities to learn how to approach difficulties calmly and independently.

Go is a wonderful hobby that has strengthened both my friendships and my abilities — I closed the album softly, still immersed in these cherished memories.

PART A: VOCABULARY (12 Words)

Study the following vocabulary words from the text. Pay attention to how each word is used in context.

#	Word	Definition	Example from Text
1	recollection (n.)	a memory or the act of remembering something.	"I had almost no recollection of this thing."
2	gaze (v.)	to look at something steadily and intently.	"A gentle, smiling face gazed at me from the pages."
3	adapt (v.)	to adjust to new conditions or a new environment.	"Before I had a chance to adapt to this unfamiliar environment."
4	mixture (n.)	a combination of different things or feelings.	"Filled with a mixture of uncertainty and curiosity."
5	assign (v.)	to give someone a particular task, position, or group.	"I was assigned to the same group as a girl with bright, pretty eyes."
6	passionate (adj.)	having or showing strong feelings or enthusiasm for something.	"Also passionate about reading."
7	waver (v.)	to become weaker or less certain; to falter.	"Our friendship has never wavered."
8	fascinating (adj.)	extremely interesting or captivating.	"How fascinating the Go club turned out to be."
9	challenging (adj.)	testing one's abilities; demanding but in a rewarding way.	"Although it was a little challenging for me at first."
10	guidance (n.)	help and advice about how to do something or how to deal with problems.	"Under the teacher's patient, step-by-step guidance."
11	remarkable (adj.)	worthy of attention; unusual or striking.	"Go is truly a remarkable game."
12	cherish (v.)	to hold something dear; to feel great love or affection for.	"Still immersed in these cherished memories."

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best word to complete each sentence.

1. She had no _____ of ever meeting him before, even though he insisted they had spoken.
a) guidance b) mixture c) recollection d) passion
2. He _____ out the window, lost in thought for what seemed like hours.
a) adapted b) wavered c) assigned d) gazed
3. It took her a few weeks to _____ to the time difference after moving abroad.
a) cherish b) adapt c) waver d) gaze
4. The teacher _____ each student a different topic for the presentation.
a) adapted b) cherished c) assigned d) wavered
5. She is _____ about protecting the environment and volunteers every weekend.
a) challenging b) remarkable c) fascinating d) passionate
6. Despite the difficulties, his determination never _____.
a) gazed b) wavered c) adapted d) assigned
7. The documentary about deep-sea creatures was absolutely _____.
a) challenging b) remarkable c) fascinating d) passionate
8. Learning a new language as an adult can be _____, but the rewards are worth it.
a) fascinating b) challenging c) remarkable d) passionate
9. The school counselor offered valuable _____ to students applying for university.
a) recollection b) mixture c) guidance d) assignment
10. The scientist made a _____ discovery that changed the field of medicine forever.
a) passionate b) challenging c) fascinating d) remarkable

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

Complete each sentence with the correct word from the box.

recollection adapt mixture cherish gaze guidance
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1. She could only _____ at the beautiful sunset, completely speechless.
2. His _____ of the accident was very unclear because it happened so long ago.
3. Moving to a new country means you have to _____ to different customs and habits.
4. She felt a _____ of excitement and nervousness before her first performance.
5. I will always _____ the time I spent with my grandparents during summer holidays.
6. Without proper _____ from a mentor, it can be difficult to make important career decisions.

waver passionate fascinating challenging remarkable assign
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7. The coach will _____ each player a specific position for tomorrow's game.
8. She is deeply _____ about music and practices the piano for hours every day.
9. The history of ancient Egypt is truly _____; there is always something new to discover.
10. The final level of the game was so _____ that only a few players could complete it.
11. The little girl showed _____ courage for someone her age when she spoke in front of the whole school.
12. Even when things got tough, her belief in herself never _____.

PART B: GRAMMAR (4 Patterns)

Study the following grammar structures from the text.

Pattern 1: "Before + subject + had a chance to + verb"

Form: Before + subject + had a chance to + base verb, + main clause

Use: To express that something happened before an opportunity arose.

Example from text: *"Before I had a chance to adapt to this unfamiliar environment, my mind was filled with fear and anxiety."*

More examples:

- Before she had a chance to respond, the phone disconnected.
- Before we had a chance to say goodbye, the train had already left.
- Before he had a chance to explain, his boss walked away.

Pattern 2: "turn out to be + adjective/noun"

Form: Subject + turn(s)/turned + out + to be + adjective/noun

Use: To describe a result or discovery that was different from what was expected.

Example from text: *"The girl, named Jola, turned out to be fantastic at painting."*

More examples:

- The exam turned out to be easier than I expected.
- The quiet student turned out to be an incredible singer.
- The old restaurant turned out to be the best one in town.

Pattern 3: "not only... but also..."

Form: Subject + not only + verb/adjective + but also + verb/adjective

Use: To emphasize that two things are true, especially when the second adds something important or surprising.

Example from text: *"Go is truly a remarkable game that not only challenges our thinking ability but also provides valuable opportunities."*

More examples:

- She not only speaks French but also writes poetry in it.
- The project not only improved our skills but also strengthened our teamwork.
- This book is not only entertaining but also deeply educational.

Pattern 4: "What surprised me (even more) was + how/that clause"

Form: What surprised me (even more) was + how/that + clause

Use: To highlight something surprising, often building on a previous point.

Example from text: *"What surprised me even more was how fascinating the Go club turned out to be."*

More examples:

- What surprised me was how quickly she learned to play the piano.
- What surprised me even more was that he remembered my birthday after all these years.
- What surprised her was how calm she felt before the performance.

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

Choose the best answer to complete each sentence.

1. Before she had a chance _____ her speech, the event was canceled.
a) finishing b) to finish c) finish d) finished
2. The movie turned out _____ much better than the reviews suggested.
a) being b) be c) to be d) been
3. The trip not only broadened our horizons _____ brought us closer as a family.
a) and also b) but also c) and too d) but too
4. What surprised everyone was _____ calm she remained during the crisis.
a) what b) which c) that d) how
5. Before they had a chance to _____ the problem, the system crashed again.
a) fixed b) fixing c) fix d) fixes
6. The new student turned out to _____ the best player on the team.
a) been b) being c) be d) was
7. She not only sings beautifully _____ plays three instruments.
a) and also b) but also c) also d) but too
8. _____ surprised me even more was that he had already finished the project.
a) That b) It c) Which d) What

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation

Rewrite each sentence using the pattern indicated in parentheses.

Before + subject + had a chance to + verb

1. I didn't get to read the instructions. The teacher started the test.

(Before I...)

2. She didn't get to pack her bags. Her ride arrived.

(Before she...)

turn out to be

3. Everyone thought the project would fail, but it was a huge success.

(The project turned out...)

4. The restaurant looked ordinary from the outside, but the food was amazing.

(The restaurant turned out...)

not only... but also...

5. The program teaches students about science. It also builds their teamwork skills.

(The program not only...)

6. He is a talented musician. He is also an excellent painter.

(He is not only...)

What surprised me (even more) was...

7. I was surprised by how much the city had changed in just five years.

(What surprised me...)

8. She was surprised that her old friend still remembered her phone number.

(What surprised her...)

ANSWER KEY

Vocabulary Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. c) recollection 2. d) gazed 3. b) adapt 4. c) assigned 5. d) passionate
6. b) wavered 7. c) fascinating 8. b) challenging 9. c) guidance 10. d) remarkable

Vocabulary Practice 2: Fill in the Blanks

1. gaze 2. recollection 3. adapt 4. mixture 5. cherish 6. guidance
7. assign 8. passionate 9. fascinating 10. challenging 11. remarkable 12. wavered

Grammar Practice 1: Multiple Choice

1. b) to finish 2. c) to be 3. b) but also 4. d) how
5. c) fix 6. c) be 7. b) but also 8. d) What

Grammar Practice 2: Sentence Transformation (Sample Answers)

1. Before I had a chance to read the instructions, the teacher started the test.
2. Before she had a chance to pack her bags, her ride arrived.
3. The project turned out to be a huge success.
4. The restaurant turned out to be amazing.
5. The program not only teaches students about science but also builds their teamwork skills.
6. He is not only a talented musician but also an excellent painter.
7. What surprised me was how much the city had changed in just five years.
8. What surprised her was that her old friend still remembered her phone number.